Cheng Chen

Prospective PhD Applicant

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Major rank 3/87
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Summary

- EE undergrad at Tongji (rank **3/87**). Research on **multimodal AI** and **trustworthy AI**.
- Accepted papers at **IJCAI**, **IJCNN**, **ICANN**, **ACM MM**; submission to **NeurIPS**.

Education

B.Eng. in Electrical Engineering, Tongji University, Shanghai — 2023.09 – Present
Major rank: **3/87**; CET-6: **519**.

Research

OrthKD: Extracting Generalized Clinical Knowledge from Heterogeneous Teachers for Lightweight Deployment — IJCAI 2026
C. Chen*, Y. Xu*, M. Cao. **Accepted; co-first; oral.**
Distill multiple clinical models into one small model without inheriting each teacher's bias.

If You Hear It, Help Find It: Orthogonal Knowledge Distillation for Open-Vocabulary Audio-Visual Event Localization — ACM MM 2026
Y. Xu*, **C. Chen***, W. Lei. **Accepted; co-first; oral.**
Open-vocabulary audio-visual event localization with orthogonal knowledge distillation.

Enabling Visual Reasoning in Text-Only LLMs via Symbolic Scene Descriptions — IJCNN 2026
W. Lei, M. Cao, C. Ye, Y. Xu, **C. Chen**. **Accepted; corresponding author.**
Describe scenes in symbols so text-only LLMs can reason about images.

Beyond Relevance: Counter-Evidence Planning in a Controlled Budgeted RAG Testbed — ICANN 2026
Y. Cai, Y. Xu, **C. Chen**. **Accepted; corresponding author.**
Plan retrieval under a fixed budget, including evidence that might disagree.

Neural-Operator Risk Assessment for Deployable Risk Triage — NeurIPS 2026
C. Chen et al. **Under review; first author.**
Flag risky neural-operator outputs in one forward pass.

Awards

Provincial First Prize, China Robot and Artificial Intelligence Competition — 2026
National 2nd Prize, Global Campus AI Algorithm Elite Competition — 2025
National 3rd Prize, Embedded Chip & System Design Competition — 2025
Provincial Second Prize, National College Student Mathematics Competition (CMC) — 2024
Provincial Second Prize, National College Student Mathematics Competition (CMC) — 2025

Skills

- **Experience:** Familiar with common research workflows and tools, including **Python**, **PyTorch**, **Git**, **LaTeX**, experiment tracking, and LLM/agent prototyping for literature review, coding, and analysis.
- **Writing:** English level sufficient to read and understand research papers; familiar with the focus, process, and logic of both academic writing and project writing.
- **Passion:** Genuinely enthusiastic about learning and exploration, and eager to push into areas I have not worked in yet.